

Can ExaModels Power JuMP on GPUs?

Blessing and curse of aggressive typing

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What is ExaModels?

- Algebraic modeling system in Julia, JuMP-inspired syntax.

Example: *Goddard rocket — maximize final altitude.*

```
using ExaModels, NLPModelsIpopt

nh, h_0, v_0, m_0, g_0 = 200, 1.0, 0.0, 1.0, 1.0
T_c, h_c, v_c, m_c = 3.5, 500.0, 620.0, 0.6
c_e = 0.5*sqrt(g_0*h_0); m_f = m_c*m_0
D_c = 0.5*v_c*(m_0/g_0); T_max = T_c*m_0*g_0

core = ExaCore(minimize=false, concrete=Val{true})

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- ▶ Distinguishing feature: GPU-compatible modeling — more on this later.

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- ▶ Distinguishing feature: GPU-compatible modeling — more on this later.
- ▶ Design philosophy: not optimized for ease-of-use, optimized for runtime performance. Aim: the fastest modeling system for building and running optimization solves.

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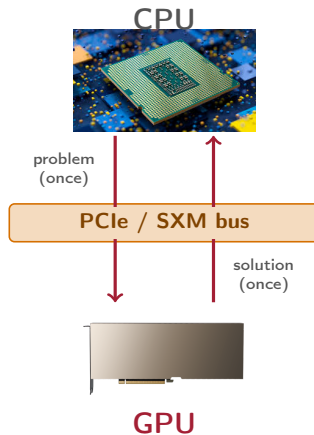
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```

Why a GPU-compatible modeling language?

LP / QP / DCP — not strictly needed

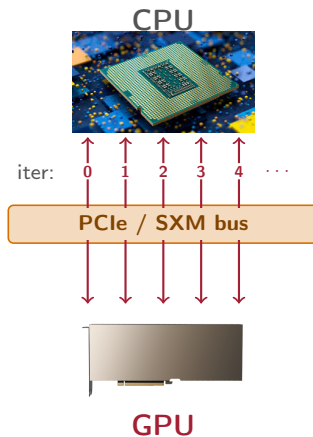
- ▶ Canonical forms $(A, b, c, \dots) \Rightarrow$ **one-shot CPU $\rightarrow$ GPU copy** of problem data
- ▶ Transfers can be an overhead, but the cost is **amortized** over many solver iterations
- ▶ Existing **GPU-native solvers** in this class already work this way: CuClarabel, cuPDLP+
 $\Rightarrow$ For LP / QP / DCP, a **GPU-native modeling language** may not add much value



Why a GPU-compatible modeling language?

NLP — the picture is different

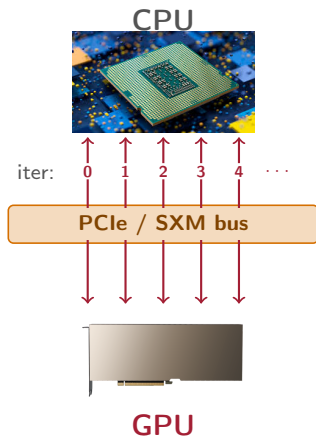
- ▶ Solver queries the modeling layer at every iteration via callbacks —
 $f(x)$, $g(x)$, $\nabla_x f(x)$, $\nabla_x g(x)$, $\nabla_{xx}^2 L(x, \lambda)$
- ▶ Each query depends on the current iterate —
no one-shot transfer
- ▶ Without GPU-native callbacks, every iteration pays a CPU↔GPU round-trip: significant per-iteration overhead, no amortization



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- ▶ Without GPU-native callbacks, every iteration pays a CPU↔GPU round-trip: significant per-iteration overhead, no amortization
- ▶ JuMP today does not emit GPU-native callbacks. Fine: modeling infrastructure stays on CPU, as long as the callbacks themselves run on the device



The ExaModels JuMP Interface: Status Quo

```
using JuMP, ExaModels, CUDA, MadNLP, MadNLPGPU

# Build the JuMP model
N = 100
jm = Model()
@variable(jm, x[i=1:N], start = isodd(i) ? -1.2 : 1.0)
@objective(jm, Min, sum(100*(x[i+1] - x[i]^2)^2 + (1 - x[i])^2 for i = 1:N-1))

# Path 1 --- Direct conversion to an ExaModel
em = ExaModel(jm; backend = CUDABackend())
result = madnlp(em)

# Path 2 --- ExaModels as a JuMP optimizer
set_optimizer(jm, () -> ExaModels.Optimizer(MadNLP.madnlp, CUDABackend()))
optimize!(jm)
```

- Currently an **experimental feature**: it works, but with **big caveats** — discussed in the next slides

JuMP → ExaModels layer is slow

JuMP route

```
function build_via_jump(N)
    jm = Model()
    @variable(jm, x[i=1:N],
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    return ExaModel(jm)
end
```

```
julia> @btime build_via_jump(10^5);
2.230 s (28307923 allocations: 1.06 GiB)
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Native ExaModels

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function build_native(N)
    core = ExaCore(concrete = Val(true))
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- ▶ $\sim 7\,200\times$ faster build, $\sim 350\times$ less memory, $\sim 360,000\times$ fewer allocations
- ▶ The gap grows with N

Where the gap comes from: JuMP unrolls into a type-erased array

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N = 100
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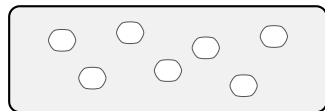
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julia> moi = backend(jm);

julia> obj = moi.model_cache.model.objective;

julia> obj.scalar_nonlinear.args |> typeof
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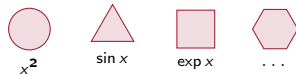
- JuMP stores the objective as an **enumerated array of expression trees** in a flat `Vector{Any}` — element types erased

`obj.scalar_nonlinear.args :: Vector{Any}`



clouds = unknown types

↓
classify
(type inference
per node)



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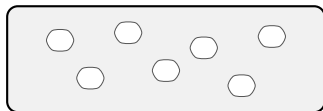
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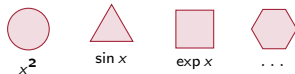
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- ▶ JuMP stores the objective as an **enumerated array of expression trees** in a flat `Vector{Any}` — element types erased
- ▶ The ExaModels–JuMP extension walks every node, **infers its type**, classifies it into an operator pattern (x^2 , $\sin x$, $\exp x$, ...) — **per-node type inference dominates the cost**

Where the gap comes from: JuMP unrolls into a type-erased array

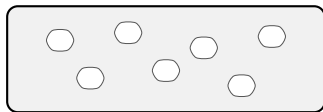
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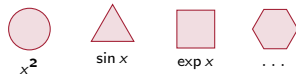
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- ▶ The ExaModels–JuMP extension walks every node, **infers its type**, classifies it into an operator pattern (x^2 , $\sin x$, $\exp x$, ...) — **per-node type inference dominates the cost**
- ▶ Worse: covering **all of JuMP's syntax** (every operator, container, macro) is **provably**

One remedy: piggyback on JuMP (GenOpt.jl by @blegat)



```
using GenOpt, JuMP, CUDA, MadNLP

model = Model()
@constraint(model, [i in 1:n], x[1,i] == x0[i], container = ParametrizedArray) # grouped constraint
@objective(model, Min, lazy_sum(0.5 * R[j] * u[i,j]^2 for i in 1:N, j in 1:p)) # grouped sum

set_optimizer(model, () -> GenOpt.ExaOptimizer(madnlp, CUDABackend()))
optimize!(model)
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- Uses JuMP's own **extension hooks** so the algebraic patterns **never get unrolled** — ExaModels sees the structured representation directly

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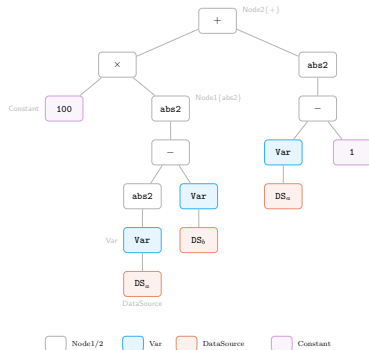
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- ▶ Minimal model rewrite: `container = ParametrizedArray` on `@constraint`, `lazy_sum` on `@objective`
- ▶ A really cool proof-of-concept route — I'm thinking about something else next.

ExaModels: the type *is* the tree

```
core = ExaCore(concrete = Val(true))
@add_var(core, x, N)
@add_obj(core,
    100*(x[i-1]^2 - x[i])^2 + (x[i-1] - 1)^2
    for i = 2:N)
em = ExaModel(core)
```

```
julia> ExaModels.fulltype_display!(true);

julia> typeof(em.objs[1].f.f)
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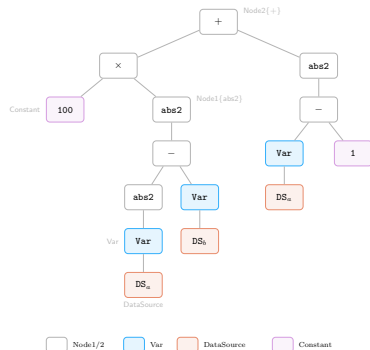
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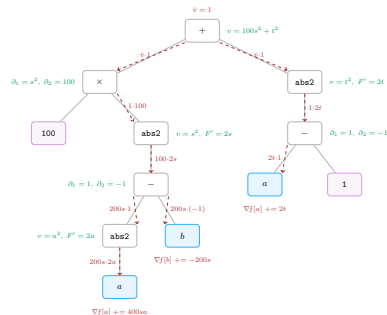
- ▶ ExaModels encodes the algebraic structure directly into the type system
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- ▶ At compile time the structure is fully known $\Rightarrow$ model creation, AD, and evaluation are specialized for this algebraic expression

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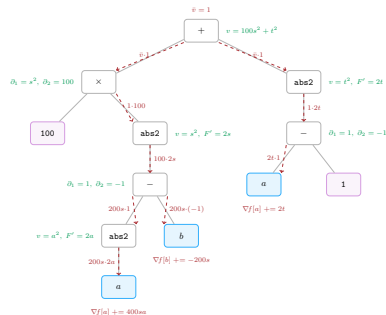
- Forward (green) and reverse (red) pass propagate through the *same typed tree*

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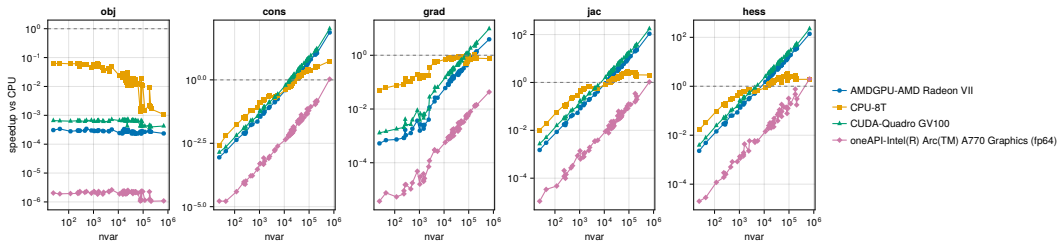
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- ▶ Forward (green) and reverse (red) pass propagate through the *same typed tree*
- ▶ Both passes can be **compiled for this `Node2{...}` type**
⇒ at runtime, **no type inference** on the tree

Blessing: Portability and performance

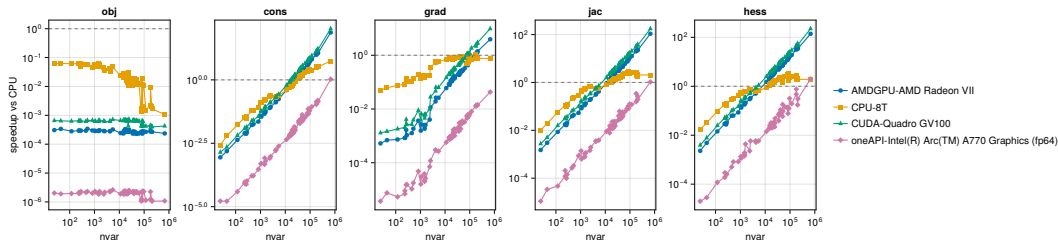
AD-callback speedup vs CPU-1T baseline, AC OPF (PGLIB-OPF)



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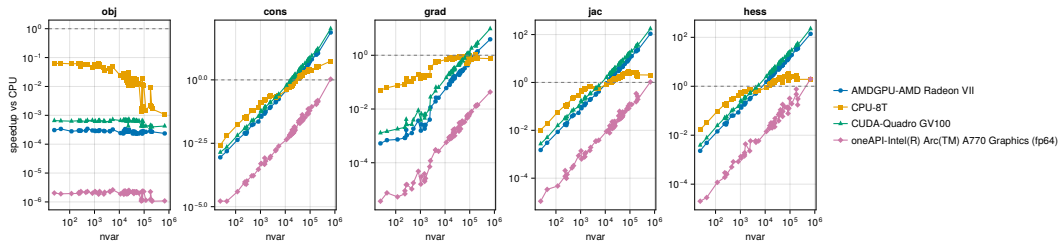
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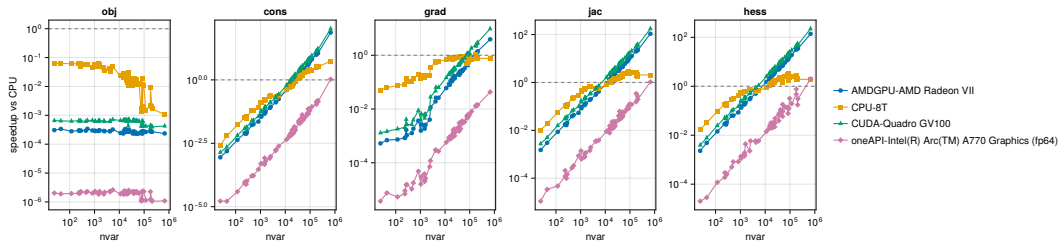
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- ▶ More benchmark results presented at **SIAM Optimization 2026** (MS369, Fri June 5)

Blessing: AOT compile to a standalone binary

```
module MySolve
using ExaModels, NLPModelsIpoptLite
function (@main)(ARGS)
    N = 100
    core = ExaCore(concrete = Val(true))
    @add_var(core, x, N; start = (isodd(i) ? -1.2 : 1.0 for i = 1:N))
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    result = ipopt(ExaModel(core); print_level = 0)
    println(Core.stdout, "status = ", result.status)
    return result.status == 0 ? 0 : 1
end
end # module
```

```
$ juliac --trim=safe -o rosenbrock MySolve.jl  # compile to a standalone executable
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- ▶ **Aggressive typing + full inlining**: LLVM IR is one giant block for the typed ExaModel

Curse: compile-once per algebraic pattern

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function build_v1(N)
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0.088402 seconds (316.07 k allocations: 15.612 MiB, 99.96% compilation time)

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- ▶ Same algebraic pattern $\Rightarrow$ **cached, instant rebuild**
- ▶ A **slight change** (one extra term) $\Rightarrow$ **everything recompiles** ($\sim 99\%$ compilation time)

Maybe an alternative: ExaModels as a JuMP backend for GPU acceleration

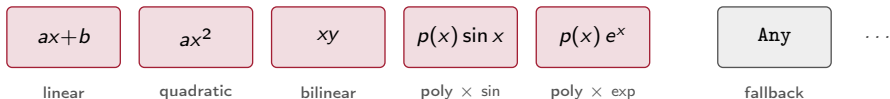
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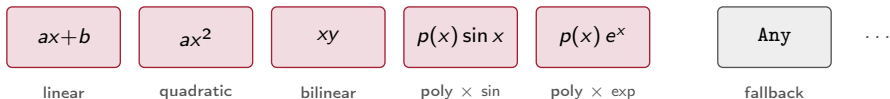
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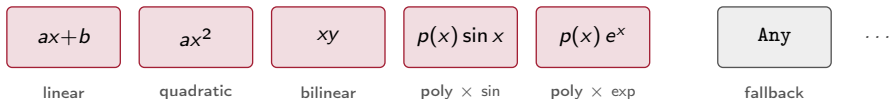


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- ▶ JuMP authors against these blocks; ExaModels **dispatches statically** on the common patterns; the Any bucket keeps today's per-element inference path
- ▶ Implication for JuMP: a move from **purely interpreted** model construction toward **more typed + compiled** — good and bad. Just an idea.

Summary

<https://github.com/exanauts/ExaModels.jl>

Slides: <https://sshin23.github.io/slides-jump-dev-2026/main.pdf>

- ▶ Encoding the algebraic structure in the type buys us GPU-native callbacks, portability, and AOT compilation
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Continuing this thread at SIAM Optimization 2026

“The State of ExaModels” — MS369, Fri June 5, 11:10 BST.

Can ExaModels Power JuMP on GPUs?

Blessing and curse of aggressive typing

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